

Gazpacho

THIS RECIPE RESULTS in a finely chopped soup; using a lower setting on the food processor will keep the ingredients chunky.

3 cups V8 juice

1/4 cup lemon juice

2 cloves garlic, peeled

5 ripe tomatoes,
peeled*

1 carrot, peeled and
in chunks

1 small onion,
in chunks

1 cucumber, peeled
and chopped

1 green pepper, seeded
and quartered

1/4 cup fresh parsley

1/4 cup fresh basil or
cilantro

1/4 cup olive oil

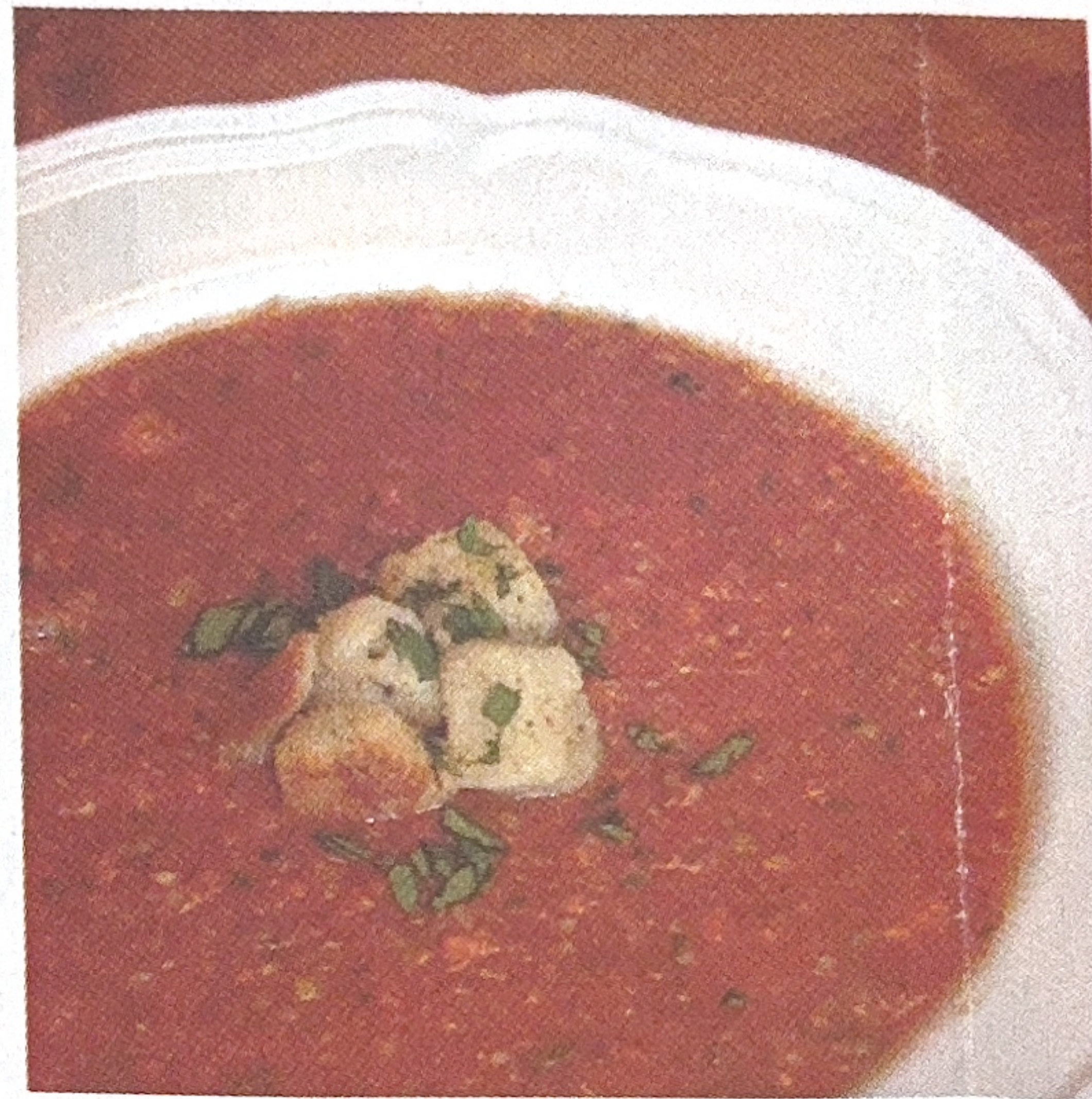
1 small jalapeño
pepper, seeded
(optional)

1 teaspoon salt
or to taste

1 teaspoon
pepper or to taste

In a food processor, combine 1 cup V8 juice, lemon juice, garlic, 2 tomatoes and one-third of the carrot, onion, cucumber, green pepper, parsley and basil. Process, then pour into a large bowl. Repeat the process, using 1 cup V8 juice, olive oil, jalapeño pepper, 1 tomato and one-third of the remaining vegetables.

Repeat the process, using the last cup of V8 juice and the remaining tomato and vegetables.



PHOTOS BY LAURA LANGSTON

Mix the three batches together. Add salt and pepper to taste.

Refrigerate for at least 4 hours before serving. Garnish with chopped cucumber or tomato, croutons, slivered basil or a drizzle of olive oil. Makes 8 cups.

* To easily peel tomatoes, drop in a pot of boiling water for 1 to 2 minutes, until skin pulls back. Remove from boiling water, peel and use.